WP-4B-03: Oral amoxicillin

Example General Hospital, Ward 4B. Version 3 (fictional). Owner: Ward 4B nurse in charge (fictional role).

FICTIONAL TRAINING DOCUMENT. Not clinical guidance. Example General Hospital is fictional.

Scope

Adult inpatients on Ward 4B prescribed oral amoxicillin.

Before the first dose

Check the allergy record in MedTrack. If a penicillin allergy is recorded, or the allergy status is not recorded, do not give the dose. Contact the prescriber.

Dosing times on Ward 4B

Doses prescribed three times daily are given at 08:00, 14:00 and 22:00. The usual adult dose is 500 mg, but always give the dose on the prescription.

Missed or late doses

Give a missed dose as soon as it is noticed, unless the next dose is due within 2 hours. In that case skip the missed dose and record the reason. Never give two doses together.

Reactions

New rash: hold the next dose and inform the prescriber. Signs of anaphylaxis such as breathing difficulty, facial swelling or collapse: stop amoxicillin and call the emergency team immediately.

Review

Ward 4B local rule: the prescriber reviews every antibiotic course at 48 hours. Prompt the review if it is not recorded.